

BUILDING BLOCKS — Part 2

Problems of Tribal Communities | Anthropology Paper 2 | Quick Revision

7 Blocks, 1 per problem: Each block = Scholar + Case Study + Data + Reasons + Consequences + Way Forward + Govt Initiative + Anthro Significance + Memory Aid. Learn 7 blocks → answer any tribal problems question.

1 LAND ALIENATION

Scholar	 L.P. Vidyarthi — "Land alienation is the root cause of all tribal unrest"  Dhebar Commission — "Loss of land = loss of livelihood, dignity, identity"  Walter Fernandes — displacement = development-induced impoverishment  B.K. Roy Burman — class differentiation within tribe after land alienation
Case Study	Koraput (Odisha) — tribal landholdings fell 50% in 20 years (Xaxa, 2001) Narmada Valley — 2 lakh displaced (majority Adivasi); Narmada Bachao Andolan (1985) Soliga (Biligirirangana) — allowed to stay in reserve → tiger population increased (co-existence model) Tharu & Bhoksa (U.P.) — post-Partition moneylenders grabbed land through fraudulent contracts Khuntkatti (Mundas) & Bhuinhari (Oraons) — collective ownership systems collapsed
Data	50% land loss in Koraput (1970-90) Narmada: 30 major + 135 medium + 3,000 small dams Karanpura: 75,000 ha acquired in Jharkhand Kanha: 450 Baiga/Gond families evicted (2014)
Reasons	1. Chronic indebtedness → land mortgaged to moneylenders 2. Mining & industrial projects (Vedanta, BALCO, coal blocks) 3. Dams & infrastructure (Narmada, Polavaram, Sardar Sarovar) 4. National parks & wildlife sanctuaries (Kanha, Kuno, Orang) 5. Colonial forest policies (Indian Forest Act, 1927 — removed community ownership) 6. Court manipulation by moneylenders exploiting tribal illiteracy
Consequences	1. Loss of livelihood & ecological survival base 2. Erosion of traditional institutions (Khuntkatti, Bhuinhari collapse) 3. Class formation within tribe — new landlords vs labourers (Roy Burman) 4. Distress migration to cities, brick kilns, construction sites 5. Tribal unrest & resistance movements (NBA, Niyamgiri)
Way Forward	1. Strengthen FRA implementation — recognise community forest rights 2. Enforce LARR Act 2013 — mandatory consent + fair R&R 3. Promote co-existence models (Soliga success) over eviction 4. Participatory governance — tribal consent in all development projects
Govt Initiative	FRA 2006 (individual + community forest rights) LARR Act 2013 (fair compensation + R&R) Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908 & Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act 1949 (restrict land transfer) PESA 1996 (Gram Sabha must approve land acquisition) Fifth Schedule (Governor regulates transfer in Scheduled Areas)
Anthro Significance	Land = total social fact — ties identity, kinship, ritual, ecology into one system. Collapse of collective ownership shows market forces disintegrate tribal social organisation. Soliga case proves indigenous ecological knowledge serves conservation better than exclusion. Roy Burman challenges the egalitarian thesis of tribal society.

MEMORY AID

"VIDYARTHI says LAND = LIFE"

6 Causes: Debt | Mining | Dams | Parks | Forest Act | Courts = **"D-M-D-P-F-C"**

5 Consequences: Livelihood | Institutions | Class | Migration | Unrest = **"LICMU"**

3 key cases: Koraput (50% gone) | Narmada (2 lakh displaced) | Soliga (co-existence works)

"NKS — Narmada Kicked, Soliga Stayed"

2 POVERTY

Scholar	 B.D. Sharma — Five Levels of Deprivation: Rights denied → Means lost → Wages cheated → Liberty sold → Spirit broken  D.N. Majumdar — "tribal poverty = outcome of dislocation from ecological niche" L.P. Vidyarthi — vicious cycle of poverty in Ranchi tribal studies
Case Study	Saharias (Kuno, M.P.) — Asmita Kabra (2009): 80% BPL after losing forest access post-relocation Adivasi tea workers (Assam) — earn less than non-tribals for same work (Level 3: wages cheated) Tribal women (Jharkhand/Odisha) — trafficked due to poverty (Level 4: liberty sold)
Data	STs BPL: rural 45.3%, urban 24.1% (2011-12) — declined from 62.3% (2004-05) but still poorest among all groups Saharias: 80% BPL after relocation 54% tribal homes lack improved sanitation 40% higher infant mortality than national average
Reasons	1. Dislocation from ecological niche — forest/land access cut off (Majumdar) 2. Colonial & post-colonial displacement (dams, mining, parks) 3. Moneylender exploitation — land mortgaged, debt trap 4. India's growth (Green Revolution, industrialisation) bypassed subsistence tribal economy 5. Weak implementation of welfare schemes (IRDP, PDS, TSP fail to reach remote areas)
Consequences	1. Chronic indebtedness & bonded labour 2. Health deterioration — malnutrition, high infant mortality 3. Inter-generational transmission — poor schooling + malnutrition = vicious cycle (Vidyarthi) 4. Loss of autonomy — dependence on MGNREGA/PDS weakens subsistence systems 5. Human trafficking — women & girls from Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh
Way Forward	1. Strengthen FRA, PESA, land-tenancy laws 2. Community-based forest management & eco-tourism 3. Livelihood diversification through skill development 4. Participatory planning — respect tribal consent in development
Govt Initiative	TSP (1974-75) — funds proportional to tribal population IRDP — assisted 42% tribal families MGNREGA — 20% workers are STs PM-JANMAN 2024 — focuses on PVTGs Van Dhan Yojana — MFP value addition FRA 2006 — restores forest access
Anthro Significance	Poverty as structural violence, not cultural deficit — B.D. Sharma rejects the "culture of poverty" thesis. Majumdar's ecological niche concept links to Vidyarthi's Nature-Man-Spirit Complex — removing habitat destroys the entire social system. Poverty is a consequence of forced integration, not isolation.
MEMORY AID — B.D. Sharma's 5 Levels Rights denied → Means lost → Wages cheated → Liberty sold → Spirit broken "R-M-W-L-S" — think of a person falling 5 stairs Forest taken → Becomes labourer → Paid half → Daughter trafficked → Gives up fighting <i>Majumdar = "M" = Mismatch with ecological niche Saharia = "S" = Severed from forest (80% BPL)</i>	

3 INDEBTEDNESS

Scholar	 Christoph von Fürer-Haimendorf — shift from barter to money economy exposed tribals to moneylenders  Rangarajan — 36% of ST farmer households indebted to non-institutional sources  Anumeha Yadav — Goti bonded labour persists despite laws  V.G. Rao — 36.5% STD prevalence among tribal villagers (Jabalpur)
Case Study	Sahariya (Baran, Rajasthan) — Hali system of bonded labour persists despite Abolition Act 1976 Juang PVTG (Odisha) — Goti system binds families into labour for generations Bedia community — women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment Ho & Munda women (Jharkhand/Odisha) — sent as domestic servants through exploitative networks
Data	36% ST farmers indebted — mostly to non-institutional sources Two bonded labour systems still active: Hali (Sahariya) + Goti (Juang) 36.5% STD prevalence (V.G. Rao, Jabalpur)
Reasons	1. Loss of forest rights — colonial Forest Act 1927 destroyed livelihood base 2. Shift from barter to money economy (Fürer-Haimendorf) 3. Poor cultivation methods — no surplus to save 4. Extravagant ceremonial spending — marriage, festivals at high interest 5. Formal credit too complex — tribals return to informal moneylenders
Consequences	1. Bonded labour — Hali (Sahariya) & Goti (Juang) systems persist 2. Land seizure by creditors → chronic landlessness 3. Trafficking & sexual exploitation (Bedia women, Ho/Munda domestic servants) 4. Health impacts — STDs, malnutrition from poverty cycle 5. Hereditary debt — bondage passes across generations
Way Forward	1. Empower through secure land rights + community banking 2. Financial literacy and education on debt management 3. Expand institutional credit (NSTFDC, micro-credit SHGs) 4. Strict enforcement of Bonded Labour Abolition Act
Govt Initiative	Bonded Labour Abolition Act 1976 Fifth Schedule (regulates moneylending in Scheduled Areas) NSTFDC (concessional credit) AMSY (4% loans for tribal women) MCF Scheme (micro credit — up to 5L per SHG) M.P. 2019 — waived all loans from unlicensed moneylenders Orissa Debt Bondage Abolition Act 1948
Anthro Significance	Transition from reciprocity to market exchange — Fürer-Haimendorf documents how monetisation disrupted tribal economies based on barter and mutual obligation. Hali/Goti = institutionalised exploitation — law without structural change cannot end embedded socio-economic relations. Debt becomes a mechanism of social control .

MEMORY AID

Barter → Money → Moneylender → Bondage

Fürer-Haimendorf = "the Foreign scholar who saw the **Fall** from barter to bondage"

Two bonded systems: **Hali** + **Goti** = "**HG**" (Hali-Goti, both illegal, both alive)

36-36 hook: 36% indebted (Rangarajan) | 36.5% STDs (V.G. Rao)

"More than 1 in 3 tribal farmers in debt"

Scholar	 Verrier Elwin — "Education must be of the forest and not against the forest" S.C. Dube (1955) — educated intermediaries form tribal elite serving self-interest Xaxa Committee (2014) — early marriage and household chores reduce girls' schooling
Case Study	Gonds (M.P.) — Hindi-medium education culturally alien, difficult to relate Chenchu/Konda Reddi PVTGs (A.P.) — girls leave after Class V, no female teachers/hostels Maharashtra — 29 tribal girls exploited in hostels (2011-2016) KISS Odisha — teaches and validates 10 tribal dialects (success model)
Data	ST literacy 59% vs national 73% (Census 2011) — 14-point gap ST male 68.5% vs female below 50% — nearly 20-point gender gap Highest: Mizoram 91.6% Lowest: A.P. 49.2%
Reasons	1. Language barrier — schools teach in Hindi/regional language, not mother tongue 2. Poor infrastructure — few schools, no electricity, no female teachers in remote areas 3. Cultural disconnect — curriculum alien to tribal worldview (Elwin) 4. Gender disparity — early marriage, safety concerns, no girls' hostels 5. Low parental motivation — education seen as pulling children away from community
Consequences	1. High dropout rates — linguistic and cultural alienation 2. Limited employability — lack of English/technical skills despite reservation 3. Elite capture — educated tribals become middlemen, not community leaders (Dube) 4. Widening gender gap — female literacy stuck below 50% 5. Institutional abuse — exploitation of tribal children in hostels/shelters
Way Forward	1. Bilingual education as per NEP 2020 + TSR Subramanian Committee 2. Recruit local tribal-language teachers; expand EMRS 3. Girls' schools + hostels + bicycles (Bihar model) + menstrual hygiene 4. Protect children in institutions — accountability mechanisms
Govt Initiative	EMRS (Eklavya Model Residential Schools) NEP 2020 (bilingual education + local knowledge) Art 350A (mother tongue at primary stage) Art 15(4) (special educational provisions) MLE Programme (Odisha 2006) — 3,385 tribal teachers, dictionaries in 20 languages Ashram Schools Pre-Matric & Post-Matric Scholarships
Anthro Significance	Elwin's principle = education as cultural continuity, not cultural replacement. Mainstream schooling imposes dominant cultural values — a form of symbolic violence (Bourdieu). Dube's "educated intermediary" raises the insider-outsider dilemma — education can disconnect tribals from their community instead of empowering it.

MEMORY AID

Elwin = "E" = Education OF forest, not AGAINST forest

59 vs 73 — "ST literacy is **14 behind**"

Two extremes: **Mizoram = Miraculous** (91.6%) | **A.P. = Awful** (49.2%)

Dube = "D" for Double-edged — education empowers some, creates elite who exploit others

Gender gap: "men 68, women can't even reach 50"

5 UNEMPLOYMENT

Scholar	Richard Mahapatra — "tribals quitting farming fast, every second household in informal economy" Saiyed Zegham Murtaza — "extreme disregard of reservation norms" Bhatia — studies in Bastar link unemployment with Naxal recruitment N.C. Saxena — agriculture/forest work limited to 4-5 months, rest casual labour
Case Study	112th Parliamentary Committee (2023) — 1,199 of 3,097 ST-reserved posts in 45 central universities vacant; 3,000+ in ministries Bastar — 70% of employed tribal women = seasonal MGNREGA labourers, earn less than men Jharkhand/Odisha — mass migration to brick kilns in A.P., factories in Surat/Mumbai
Data	75% in agriculture (subsistence) Only 4.8% in regular/salaried jobs Less than 2% formally skilled MGNREGA: ST share dropped from 36% to 17-20% 1,199 posts vacant in universities
Reasons	1. Loss of traditional livelihood — forest laws + industrial expansion 2. Seasonal agriculture — only 4-5 months work (N.C. Saxena) 3. Lack of education & vocational skills — less than 2% formally trained 4. Vacant reserved posts — extreme disregard of reservation norms (Murtaza) 5. Discrimination & stereotypes in job market 6. Poor infrastructure in tribal regions — roads, internet, industries absent
Consequences	1. Distress migration — Jharkhand/Odisha to brick kilns, factories without social security 2. Naxal recruitment — joblessness fuels frustration and extremism (Bhatia, Bastar) 3. Rise in bonded labour — poverty + debt in M.P., Rajasthan (ILO, 2016) 4. Alcoholism & psychological stress 5. Women forced into domestic work, brick kilns — loss of community support
Way Forward	1. Tribal Skill Development Centres — local crafts, agro-processing, tourism 2. Fill backlog of ST-reserved posts — regular audits 3. Forest-based industries — bamboo, honey, herbal cooperatives 4. Strengthen MGNREGA — timely wages, social audits in tribal regions 5. Tribal start-ups under Start-Up India + NSTFDC funding
Govt Initiative	MGNREGA (20% workers are STs, but share declining) NSTFDC (concessional loans + entrepreneurship) VTCs (Vocational Training Centres) Tribal Employment Exchange (Trivandrum, 2018) — India's first Career & Higher Education Scheme for ST Students (2018-19) JRY (Jawahar Rozgar Yojana)
Anthro Significance	Proletarianisation — shift from self-sufficient subsistence to wage dependency reflects forced integration into capitalist economy. Seasonal unemployment shows clash between ecological rhythm of tribal economy and modern employment structures. Unemployment → extremism validates deprivation theory of social movements.
MEMORY AID 4 months work → 8 months idle → Migration or Naxalism 75-5-2 rule: 75% farming 5% salaried 2% skilled Two M's complaining: Mahapatra (quitting farming) + Murtaza (vacant posts) Bhatia = Bastar = Bombs (unemployment → Naxalism) <i>MGNREGA: "36 to 17" — tribal participation halved</i>	

Scholar	Abhay Bang Committee (2018) — tribal India faces triple burden : communicable + NCDs + mental health  P.C. Joshi — integration of ethnomedicine with PHCs could improve outcomes Dr. Abhay & Rani Bang — SEARCH initiative in Gadchiroli (success model)
Case Study	Keonjhar (Odisha) — 26% of India's iron ore, ₹15,000 cr mineral funds, yet worst child/maternal health; 74.7% pregnant women anaemic; villages 20+ km from hospital Gadchiroli (Maharashtra) — SEARCH trained village health workers for home-based newborn care → reduced neonatal mortality (community participation + local training + traditional integration)
Data	Malaria: 30% cases, 60% P. falciparum, 50% deaths TB: 703 vs 256 per lakh nationally Life expectancy: 63.9 vs 67 years 45% children stunted PHC shortfall: 27-40% Doctor shortage: 33%
Reasons	1. Mistrust in modern medicine — illness attributed to spirits; rely on ojhas, baigas 2. Poor health infrastructure — PHC shortfall 27-40%, 33% doctor shortage 3. Malnutrition — loss of forest food + protein/micronutrient deficiency 4. TSP funds diverted or underutilised 5. No tribe-specific health data — sickle-cell (central India), goitre (Himalayan tribes) ignored
Consequences	1. Life expectancy 5-6 years lower than national average 2. Triple disease burden — communicable + NCDs + mental health 3. 45% children stunted, 27% wasted — among highest in world 4. Keonjhar paradox — "richest soil, sickest people" 5. Decline of traditional medicine — indigenous healers sidelined
Way Forward	1. Integrate AYUSH + ethnomedicine with PHCs (P.C. Joshi) 2. Replicate Gadchiroli model — train local health workers, community participation 3. ASHAs/ANMs from tribal communities — builds trust 4. Restore forest rights for traditional food access (millets, tubers, wild fruits) 5. Create National Tribal Health Mission (NTHM) — proposed
Govt Initiative	NHM (tribal sub-plans + ASHA workers) Abhay Bang Committee 2018 (roadmap) Aashwasan Campaign 2022 (TB in 177 tribal districts — 10M screened) Malaria Elimination 2030 ICDS (nutrition) Poshan Abhiyaan (targets stunting/anaemia) SWASTHYA Portal (tribal health data) Mobile Medical Units
Anthro Significance	Resource curse / paradox of prosperity — Keonjhar proves extractive development benefits the state, not the indigenous population. Medical pluralism (P.C. Joshi) — recognising indigenous healing respects tribal knowledge systems. Gadchiroli proves community-based participatory health works better than top-down biomedical interventions.

MEMORY AID

Triple burden = CMD: Communicable + Mental + Developmental (NCDs)

Malaria: 30-60-50 rule — 30% cases, 60% falciparum, 50% deaths

Keonjhar paradox: "26% iron ore, 74% anaemic mothers" — richest soil, sickest people

"Bang" Committee — the name says "wake up!" | **Gadchiroli = THE success story** — always use in way forward

"Joshi joined, Bang banged" — Joshi theorised ethnomedicine, Bang implemented it

7 CROSS-CUTTING: IMPACT ON TRIBAL WOMEN

Scholar	NFHS-5 — 60% ST women anaemic; maternal mortality 167 per lakh Xaxa Committee (2014) — early marriage + chores reduce girls' schooling ICSSR study — Santhal women work 12+ hours daily
Case Study	Polavaram Dam (A.P.) — female-headed households least compensated, most food insecure Baiga/Gond women (M.P.) — managed Bewar fields, now daily wage labour Bedia community — women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment Ho & Munda women — sent as domestic servants through exploitative networks Santhal women — 12+ hr workday, eat last and least
Data	60% anaemic Maternal mortality 167 per lakh Female literacy below 50% vs male 68.5% 12+ hr workday 50% adolescent girls BMI < 18.5
Reasons	1. Displacement negotiated with men — women excluded from compensation 2. Loss of forest produce, firewood, fodder (women's traditional domains) 3. Early marriage + household burden kills girls' education 4. Debt pushes women into bonded labour, trafficking, prostitution 5. Cultural barriers to healthcare — mistrust of allopathic medicine
Consequences	1. Women eat last, compensated last, consulted last 2. Shift from autonomous cultivators to dependent wage workers 3. Trafficking & sexual exploitation (Bedia, Ho/Munda cases) 4. Worst health outcomes — anaemia, maternal mortality, malnutrition 5. Widening gender gap in literacy (20-point difference)
Way Forward	1. Joint pattas under FRA (both spouses' names) 2. Girls' schools, hostels, bicycles in tribal areas 3. AMSY and micro-credit for tribal women's entrepreneurship 4. Menstrual hygiene + institutional deliveries + tribal ASHA workers 5. Anti-trafficking enforcement + safe migration channels
Govt Initiative	FRA 2006 (joint pattas) AMSY (4% loans for ST women) Poshan Abhiyaan (targets anaemia) National Menstrual Hygiene Scheme Adivasi Mahila Shikshan Kendra (literacy) Beti Bachao Beti Padhao ITPA + Criminal Law Amendment 2013 (anti-trafficking)
Anthro Significance	Gendered impact of development — displacement disrupts women's role as custodians of food security & forest knowledge. Challenges the myth of tribal gender equality — patriarchal compensation structures coexist with matrilineal traditions. Women's triple burden (work + nutrition neglect + exclusion) shows intersectionality of gender, tribe, and class .

MEMORY AID

Women = LAST in everything: Last to eat | Last to be compensated | Last to be consulted
"PBS" — 3 cases: Polavaram (no compensation) | Baiga (field to wage) | Santhal (12hr day)
60-167-50 — 60% anaemic | 167 maternal mortality | below 50% literacy
Use this block as an "add-on" to ANY other block for "impact on women" dimension

BLOCK COMBINATIONS — "If UPSC asks about X, pick these"

Question Theme	Blocks	Must-use Scholar	Must-use Case
Land alienation & displacement	1 + 7	L.P. Vidyarthi, Dhebar, Fernandes	Koraput, Narmada, Soliga
Poverty & deprivation	2 + 3	B.D. Sharma (5 levels), Majumdar	Saharias, Assam tea workers
Indebtedness & bonded labour	3 + 1	Fürer-Haimendorf, Anumeha Yadav	Sahariya-Hali, Juang-Goti
Education	4 + 7	Verrier Elwin, Xaxa Committee	Gonds, KISS Odisha, Chenchu
Unemployment & Naxalism	5 + 2	Mahapatra, Bhatia, Murtaza	Bastar, 1199 vacant posts
Health & nutrition	6 + 7	Abhay Bang, P.C. Joshi	Keonjhar, Gadchiroli
Tribal women (any topic)	7 + any	NFHS-5, Xaxa, ICSSR	Polavaram, Bedia, Santhal
Development critique	1 + 2 + 6	Sharma, Fernandes, Majumdar	Keonjhar, Narmada, Saharias
Legislative failure	3 + 5	Murtaza, Anumeha Yadav	Hali/Goti persist, vacant posts
Way forward / solutions	6 + 4 + 2	Bang, Elwin, Sharma	Gadchiroli, EMRS, Soliga